GUARDIAN FOUNDATION REPAIR

September 2026 — Digital Advertising Report

Search Engine Advertising — Fifth Full Month

Period: September 1 – September 30, 2026 **Prepared by:** Dickson Media & Events

September closes out the program's **fifth full calendar month**. The ads were **clicked at the highest rate of the program so far**: the click-through rate reached **1.00%**, up from 0.81%, and clicks held within 6% of August even as impressions eased. Phone-call leads came in at **23**, below August's 32, and that is the first month-over-month dip since launch. The pull-back arrived in an unusually hot, dry month and lined up closely with a similar dip in Guardian's free Google listing, both of which point to seasonal demand rather than ad performance.

September produced **23 verifiable phone-call leads through Google Search** plus 24 secondary touchpoints (15 phone calls dialed from the website after an ad click, and 9 form submissions), for **47 tracked search interactions** in all. Form submissions matched August at 9, and website call clicks dipped only modestly, from 19 to 15.

1. Executive Summary

KPIs below cover the **core Google Search program** for all of September, so the figures compare directly with August and earlier months.

PHONE-CALL LEADS
23
▼ –28.1% vs August (32) · 60s+ qualified

LONG-DURATION CALLS (90S+)
17
74% of calls · ties program best

PHONE SHARE
81%
All phone actions ÷ all tracked leads

IMPRESSIONS
26,497
▼ –24.4% vs August (35,058)

CLICKS
266
▼ –6.0% vs August · CTR 1.00%

CONV. RATE
8.6%
vs 11.3% in August

> **Headline:** engagement improved while demand eased. Homeowners who saw a Guardian ad were more likely than ever to click it, and the calls that came in ran longer. Total call volume pulled back for the first time after five months of gains (**15 → 23 → 29 → 31 → 32 → 23**). That dip came in a month that was far drier and hotter than normal, and organic activity on Guardian's Google listing fell by nearly the same proportion.

2. Leads and Interactions

SOURCE	COUNT	NOTES
Calls from Google Ads (primary — 60s+ qualified)	23	The primary conversion metric: a call from someone who clicked a Google ad and stayed on the line past the 60-second qualifying mark. Down from 32 in August.
Calls from Google Ads — long-duration subset (90s+)	17	Subset of the above. Conversations of 90+ seconds usually mean the caller moved past basic questions into the details of a real project.
Call clicks from website (secondary)	15	Visitor clicked a Google ad, reached the site, then dialed the number on the page. Down from 19.
Form submissions (secondary)	9	Email-form leads, unchanged from August. Treated as secondary because this lead type books appointments at a lower rate than phone calls.
Total tracked interactions (Search)	**47**	**23 primary phone-call leads + 24 secondary touchpoints. August: 60.**

The quality of the calls is the bright spot. Seventeen of the twenty-three primary calls ran past ninety seconds, which is **74%**, up from 72% in August and level with the program's best month. Fewer homeowners called, but a larger share of those who did were ready for a substantive conversation.

Secondary actions also held up better than calls did. Form submissions were flat at 9, so the dip was concentrated in direct phone calls rather than spread across every way a homeowner can reach out.

3. Campaigns and Devices

CAMPAIGN	IMPR.	CLICKS	CTR	CONV.	CONV. RATE
SRCH — Foundation Repair	15,209	112	0.74%	12	10.7%
SRCH — Water + Crawl	10,703	109	1.02%	9	8.3%
SRCH — Branded	585	45	7.69%	2	4.4%
Total	**26,497**	**266**	**1.00%**	**23**	**8.6%**

Conversion counts reflect **primary phone-call leads only**. The 15 website call clicks and 9 form submissions are tracked separately, in line with the program's primary-vs-secondary design.

- **Foundation Repair** — 12 phone-call leads at a 10.7% conversion rate, against 16 at 13.0% in August. It remained the largest campaign and the top lead source, and its click-through rate improved from 0.60% to 0.74%.
- **Water + Crawl** — 9 leads at 8.3%, down from 13. This is the campaign most tied to active moisture problems, and in a month with well under half an inch of rain per week, fewer homeowners were dealing with water in a basement or crawl space. Its click-through rate rose to 1.02%, the highest it has posted, so the ads are connecting; there was simply less urgent need behind the searches.
- **Branded** — 2 leads, with click-through rising to 7.69%. People searching the Guardian name continue to find and click it, which keeps the company's own name protected at very low cost.

Device performance

DEVICE	IMPR.	CLICKS	CONV.
Mobile	17,719	173	16
Desktop	8,058	85	7
Tablet	720	8	0
Total	**26,497**	**266**	**23**

Mobile produced **16 of the 23** calls (70%), with desktop contributing 7. That's in line with every prior month: most foundation and moisture inquiries still start with a homeowner spotting a problem and searching on a phone right then.

4. Keyword Match-Type Performance

MATCH TYPE	IMPR.	CLICKS	CTR	CONV.	CONV. RATE
EXACT	7,877	95	1.21%	16	16.8%
PHRASE	18,620	171	0.92%	7	4.1%
Total	**26,497**	**266**	**1.00%**	**23**	**8.6%**

> **Exact match stayed the workhorse:** exact-match keywords converted at **16.8%**, about four times the 4.1% rate for phrase match, and produced **16 of September's 23 calls** from under 30% of impressions.

Exact terms are the searches with the clearest repair intent, such as a homeowner typing the specific service they need, and they kept producing calls at a strong rate even in a slower month. Phrase match brings in the wider range of ways people describe a problem; its click-through rate rose to 0.92%, though fewer of those visits turned into calls than in August.

5. Weather & Demand Backdrop

September was **unusually hot and dry** in Knoxville. McGhee Tyson Airport recorded **1.99 inches of rain against a normal of 3.49 inches**, a shortfall of 1.5 inches, and the month averaged **5.8°F warmer than normal**.

Weather like that changes what homeowners notice. Without heavy rain, fewer people find water in a basement or a soaked crawl space, which is exactly the kind of moment that triggers an urgent call. That fits September's pattern, where the moisture-focused Water + Crawl campaign saw the larger relative dip.

> **Looking ahead:** dry spells usually slow calls for a while, not for good. Once rainfall gets back to normal, we expect call volume to pick back up.

6. Google Business Profile — Organic Context

Guardian's Google Business Profile, the free listing that appears in Google Maps and local search, is separate from the paid program and provides a useful read on overall market demand. In September it registered **111** total profile interactions, down from 157 in August.

ACTION FROM THE GOOGLE LISTING	AUGUST	SEPTEMBER	CHANGE
Website clicks	69	49	−29.0%
Phone calls	47	33	−29.8%
Total profile interactions	**157**	**111**	**−29.3%**

> **Worth noting:** the listing's phone calls fell about 30%, almost exactly in step with the paid program's call volume. Because the listing is organic and untouched by the ads, a matching dip on both sides indicates fewer homeowners were looking for help in September, rather than the ads losing ground. These organic figures are separate from the paid totals above and should not be added to them.

7. October Outlook

The fundamentals heading into fall are solid. Click-through rates are at program highs across every campaign, the long-call share matches the program's best, and exact-match keywords keep converting at a strong rate. The program is well placed to capture demand as it returns.

On the Search side, priorities are unchanged: keep Foundation Repair and Water + Crawl building call history, maintain strong coverage on the exact-match terms with proven call records, and use phrase match to surface additional high-intent searches.

Fall is typically one of the stronger periods for foundation and waterproofing inquiries. Returning rain after a dry summer tends to bring soil movement and moisture problems to the surface, and homeowners who noticed issues over the summer often look to have them addressed before winter.

> **The trend in context:** phone-call leads ran **15, 23, 29, 31, 32** through August and **23** in September. One softer month following a dry, hot stretch is consistent with normal seasonal ebb and flow, and the engagement signals underneath it (click-through and call length) moved in the right direction.